

Priority Six

Community First

Government That Listens. Leadership That Serves.

"The greatest strength of West Covina is not City Hall. It is the people who call this community home."

Why This Matters

Government exists to serve its residents.

Not the other way around.

Throughout my career in education, counseling, administration, and community leadership, I have learned one lesson over and over again:

The people closest to the problem are often closest to the solution.

Good leaders don't pretend to have all the answers.

They ask questions.

They listen.

They learn.

Then they bring people together to solve problems.

Unfortunately, too often residents feel like important decisions have already been made before public input is ever requested.

I believe we can do better.

Government should never feel distant.

Government should be approachable.

Accessible.

Transparent.

Collaborative.

Most importantly...

Residents should always know that their voice matters.

As your Councilmember, I will work every day to restore trust between City Hall and the people it serves.

Community Engagement

"Good government begins by listening."

The best ideas rarely come from one person.

They come from residents who experience our City's successes and challenges every day.

That is why I believe meaningful community engagement should become part of every major decision.

Not after decisions are made.

Before they are made.

As Your Councilmember, I Will:

- Hold regular Town Hall meetings throughout District 5 and the City.
- Conduct neighborhood listening sessions.
- Expand opportunities for public participation before major decisions are made.
- Improve transparency through regular communication with residents.
- Utilize technology to improve access to City information.
- Build stronger partnerships with neighborhood organizations.
- Encourage citizen advisory committees when appropriate.
- Continue being accessible and responsive to residents.

Government should never stop listening.

Youth & Education

"Investing in young people is one of the greatest investments any community can make."

Education has been my life's work.

For more than twenty-five years, I have dedicated my career to helping students and families overcome challenges, discover their strengths, and prepare for successful futures.

I have worked with thousands of students from every background imaginable.

I have seen firsthand what happens when young people have opportunities.

And I have seen the consequences when those opportunities are missing.

While City government does not operate our schools, it can become an important partner in supporting education, youth leadership, recreation, mentoring, and career development.

I Will Work To:

- Strengthen partnerships between the City and local school districts.
- Expand youth leadership opportunities.
- Encourage civic engagement among young people.
- Support college and career readiness initiatives.
- Promote internship opportunities with local government.
- Expand after-school and summer programming.
- Increase recreational opportunities for youth.
- Encourage volunteerism and community service.

Today's youth are tomorrow's leaders.

Our responsibility is to help prepare them.

Seniors

"A community should be judged by how it cares for those who helped build it."

Helping care for my own parents has given me a much deeper appreciation for the challenges many seniors and caregivers experience every day.

Transportation.

Healthcare.

Isolation.

Safety.

Access to services.

These challenges deserve thoughtful attention.

Our seniors have spent decades building this community.

They deserve dignity, respect, and opportunities to remain active, connected, and informed.

I Will Advocate For:

- Improved communication with our senior community.
- Greater awareness of available services.
- Expanded recreation and wellness programs.
- Transportation partnerships.
- Opportunities for social engagement.
- Emergency preparedness education.
- Programs that encourage healthy aging.
- Continued collaboration with organizations serving older adults.

Every senior deserves to know their City values them.

Mental Health

"Healthy communities begin with healthy people."

Throughout my career as an Intervention Counselor and School Psychologist, I have seen firsthand how mental health affects individuals, families, schools, workplaces, and entire communities.

Mental health should never carry stigma.

It should be treated with the same compassion and importance as physical health.

Although City government does not provide mental healthcare directly, it can play an important role in connecting residents with resources, supporting partnerships, promoting education, and encouraging prevention.

Communities thrive when people feel supported.

I Will Support:

- Mental health awareness initiatives.
- Early intervention and prevention programs.
- Partnerships with schools and healthcare providers.
- Community education.
- Crisis response collaboration.
- Family support resources.
- Efforts to reduce stigma.
- Increased awareness of available services.

Healthy minds build healthy communities.

Women's Health

"Supporting women's health is supporting families."

Women's health is deeply personal to me because of the women who have shaped my life.

My wife Alex...

Our twin daughters...

My mother...

Family members...

Friends...

Coworkers...

Residents...

Listening to their experiences has given me a greater appreciation for the healthcare challenges many women face.

Although healthcare policy is largely outside the authority of City government, West Covina can still become a leader in promoting education, community partnerships, wellness, and preventive care.

I Will Advocate For:

- Partnerships with local hospitals.
- Community health fairs.
- Women's wellness education.
- Preventive screenings.
- Family health initiatives.
- Public awareness campaigns.
- Increased access to information about available resources.
- Ensuring women's voices are considered whenever City decisions impact quality of life.

Healthy women strengthen healthy families.

Healthy families strengthen West Covina.

Veterans

"Freedom is preserved because brave men and women chose to serve."

My father-in-law proudly served our country during the Vietnam War, and I have many family members and close friends who have worn our nation's uniform.

We owe every veteran our gratitude—not only through words, but through action.

I Will Work To:

- Increase awareness of veteran services.
- Strengthen partnerships with veteran organizations.
- Honor military service throughout our community.
- Support programs that improve veterans' quality of life.
- Recognize military families for their sacrifices.

We should never forget those who sacrificed for our freedoms.

Housing & Responsible Growth

"Growth should strengthen neighborhoods—not diminish them."

West Covina must plan responsibly for the future.

Thoughtful planning means balancing housing needs with preserving the character, safety, and quality of life that residents value.

Development decisions should be guided by facts, community input, and long-term planning—not short-term pressures.

I Will Support:

- Responsible planning.
- Transparent decision-making.
- Resident participation.
- Infrastructure that keeps pace with growth.
- Preservation of neighborhood character.
- Smart redevelopment.
- Long-term planning.

Growth should benefit the entire community.

Environmental Stewardship & Emergency Preparedness

"Preparing today protects tomorrow."

Protecting our environment and preparing for emergencies are responsibilities we owe future generations.

West Covina should continue strengthening its ability to respond to natural disasters, public health emergencies, and environmental challenges while preserving the parks, trees, and open spaces that improve our quality of life.

I Will Advocate For:

- Strong emergency preparedness planning.
- Disaster readiness education.
- Protection of parks and open spaces.
- Responsible environmental stewardship.
- Collaboration with public safety professionals.
- Community resilience planning.
- Sustainable practices that are practical and fiscally responsible.

Prepared communities are safer communities.

Community Partnerships

No City government can solve every challenge alone.

The strongest communities are built through partnerships.

Schools.

Businesses.

Faith-based organizations.

Hospitals.

Nonprofits.

Neighborhood associations.

Volunteer organizations.

Residents.

When people work together toward common goals, extraordinary things become possible.

As your Councilmember, I will continue building bridges across our community because collaboration has always been one of my greatest strengths.

My Commitment

These Six Priorities are more than campaign promises.

They represent the principles that will guide every decision I make.

I promise to:

- Listen before making decisions.
- Study the facts before reaching conclusions.
- Use reliable data to guide policy.
- Learn from proven best practices.
- Respect differing opinions.
- Work collaboratively with residents and stakeholders.
- Protect taxpayer dollars.
- Communicate honestly and transparently.
- Lead with integrity.
- Remain accessible and accountable.
- Never lose sight of who I work for—the residents of West Covina.

Leadership is not about titles.

It is about service.

It is about earning trust.

It is about making difficult decisions with honesty, humility, and courage.

I cannot promise that every decision will be easy.

But I can promise that every decision I make will be guided by one simple question:

"Is this in the best interest of the residents of West Covina?"

That question will shape every vote I cast.

Every conversation I have.

Every decision I make.

Every day I have the privilege of serving this community.

Together, We Can Build a Better West Covina

West Covina's greatest days are still ahead.

By restoring fiscal responsibility...

Keeping our neighborhoods safe...

Investing in infrastructure...

Supporting families...

Growing our economy...

And putting residents first...

We can build a City that future generations will be proud to call home.

Together, we can restore trust.

Together, we can strengthen our neighborhoods.

Together, we can improve the quality of life for every resident.

Together, we can restore West Covina as the Jewel of the San Gabriel Valley.

Resources & Leadership Inspiration

I believe good leaders never stop learning.

Throughout my career in education, counseling, administration, small business ownership, and community leadership, I have learned that the best solutions come from listening, studying the facts, learning from others, and applying proven practices.

My approach to governing is informed by research, collaboration, and evidence-based leadership, including:

Good to Great by Jim Collins

Leadership principles focused on disciplined organizations, Level 5 Leadership, accountability, continuous improvement, and building institutions that endure beyond any one individual.

Bloomberg Harvard City Leadership Initiative

The *City Leader Guide on Civic Engagement: Designing Pathways for Participatory Problem-Solving* emphasizes meaningful resident participation, collaborative leadership, and evidence-based decision-making. These principles closely align with my belief that residents should be partners in governing—not spectators.

Best Practices from Successful California Cities

I will continue studying cities that have successfully strengthened fiscal stewardship, improved public safety, revitalized parks, modernized infrastructure, supported local businesses, enhanced community engagement, and delivered measurable results for their residents.

Continuous Learning

Leadership requires humility. No elected official has all the answers, and no city has a monopoly on good ideas. I will continue learning from subject matter experts, educators, public safety professionals, business leaders, nonprofit organizations, healthcare providers, neighboring cities, and, most importantly, the residents of West Covina.

Good leaders never stop learning. Every important decision should be informed by facts, guided by integrity, and focused on improving the lives of the people we serve.